

Moving to Spain Checklist 2026

Your step-by-step guide to relocating to Spain

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3-6 Months Before Moving

- Research visa options (NLV, Digital Nomad, Student, EU registration)
- Start visa application process with required documentation
- Arrange private health insurance valid in Spain
- Research areas and neighbourhoods to live in Spain
- Start learning basic Spanish or take an online course
- Notify employer/clients of relocation plans
- Research schools (if moving with children)
- Get criminal record check from your home country
- Arrange medical certificate from your GP or physician
- Consult with tax advisor about Spanish tax residency

1-3 Months Before Moving

- Secure accommodation in Spain (rental or purchase)
- Arrange shipping or moving company for household goods
- Notify bank of international move and arrange transfers
- Set up international money transfer account (Wise, OFX, etc.)
- Cancel or redirect utilities, subscriptions, and services
- Arrange mail forwarding service
- Book flights to Spain
- Organise pet transport (if applicable, check import requirements)
- Get international driving permit (if needed for your home country)
- Translate and apostille key documents (birth certificate, diplomas, etc.)

First 30 Days in Spain

- Register on padrón (empadronamiento) at your local town hall
- Apply for TIE card (Tarjeta de Identidad de Extranjero) — deadline is critical
- Open Spanish bank account (required for most services)
- Get NIE number (Número de Identidad de Extranjero)
- Register with local health centre (centro de salud) for NHS access
- Set up utilities (electricity, water, internet, gas)
- Get Spanish SIM card or arrange mobile plan
- Register children at school (if applicable)
- Exchange driving licence (if you plan to drive)
- Arrange auto insurance if bringing a vehicle

First 3-6 Months & Ongoing

- File for Beckham Law (if eligible, within 6 months)
- Register as autónomo (self-employed) if needed
- Understand Spanish tax obligations and file first tax return
- Build emergency contacts list (doctor, dentist, police, embassy)
- Join local expat communities and networking groups
- Set calendar reminder for visa renewal (60 days before expiry)
- Arrange Spanish driving licence (if converting from abroad)
- Open investment or savings accounts for financial planning

Moving Day Tips

- Document your home contents with photos/video for insurance
- Keep important documents in a separate carry-on bag
- Request certified copies of all documents from your home country
- Check Spanish customs regulations before shipping items
- Schedule padrón registration immediately upon arrival
- The TIE card application has a strict 30-day deadline — don't miss it!
- Open a bank account within the first week of arrival

Need help? Get expert support and detailed guides at myspanishvisa.com